Risk factors for the development of kidney stones

- **Gender** – men are 2.5 times more likely to develop stones than women and have high recurrence rates
- **Age**- most common between 30 to 50 years of age
- **Family history**- risk doubles with strong family history
- **Climate**- exposure to hot climate and sweating in large amounts can concentrate the urine and reduce the volume of urine, which favours stone formation
- **Diet**- high intake of animal protein and reduced consumption of fibre and fluids
- **Weight**- overweight or severely underweight increases risk
- **Life style**- high levels of stress
- **Medical conditions**- hypertension, gout and diabetes
- **Medications** for AIDS, thyroid hormones, chemotherapy and long term antacid use.

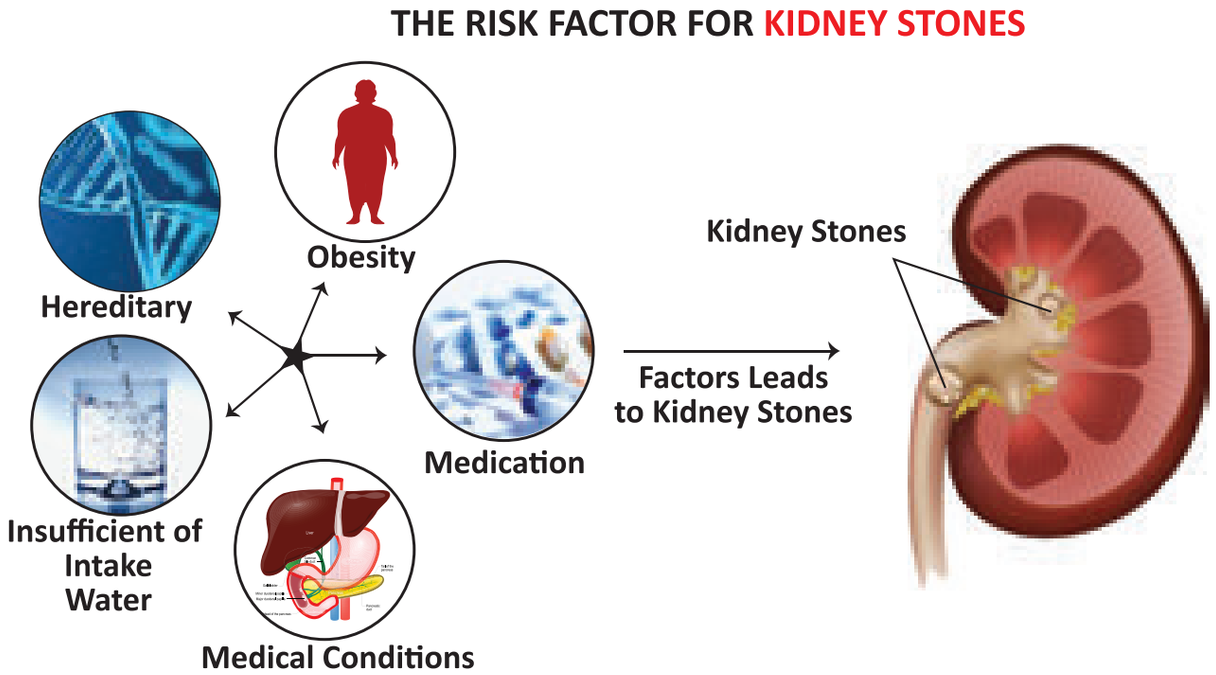
Types of kidney stones

The common forms of kidney stones belong to calcium, uric acid, struvite and cystine types.

Calcium stones

In India, calcium oxalate stones are very common. The causes are:

- Family history
- Excess calcium in the blood (hypercalcemia)
- Excess calcium in the urine (hypercalciuria)
- Excess oxalate in the urine (hyperoxaluria)
- Low level of citrate in the urine (hypocitraturia)
- Infection



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